

Kun Zhang

Research interests: corporate finance, labor economics, institutional ownership, causal inference

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Working Paper

“Institutional Common Ownership and Executive Mobility”

Supervisor: Prof. José Azar (IESE & UNAV)

Exploiting the BlackRock–BGI merger (2009) as a quasi-natural experiment, I examine how institutional common ownership shapes C-suite executive mobility. Using difference-in-differences and event study designs on a **27.8-million-row firm-pair panel** linking 13F holdings (58.9M obs.), ExecuComp data (31,959 executive-years), and Orbis director moves (24,716 transitions), I find that common ownership increases mobility through within-network labor market channels—rejecting the shadow non-compete hypothesis.

Results: Firm-level DiD: $+0.073$ ($p = 0.002$). Pair-level logit: $\Delta\lambda = +0.582$ ($p < 10^{-18}$). Event study: Post-2009 significant ($p < 0.001$). Robust to 17 pair-level checks, 5 placebo tests.

github.com/kunkunz420/common-ownership-executive-mobility

Conferences & Presentations

IESE MWOW 2026 — Madrid Work & Organizations Workshop

May 21–22, 2026

Paper presented. Keynotes: Erin L. Kelly (MIT Sloan), Lauren A. Rivera (Kellogg).

IESE AI Conference

2026

Roads to Development

2026

Education

Universidad de Navarra

Master in Economics and Finance (MEF)

Relevant: Econometrics, Mathematical Economics, Real Analysis, Statistics.

Pamplona, Spain

Sep. 2025 – Present

Hanyang University

Exchange, College of Economics and Finance

Seoul, Korea

Sep. 2023 – Jan. 2024

Yantai Institute of Technology

B.A. in Economics (International Economics & Trade)

Shandong, China

Sep. 2021 – Jul. 2024

Honors

Outstanding Exchange Student Award (Hanyang, 2024) · Outstanding Student (Yantai, 2024) · University Python Programming Champion (Yantai, 2023)

Experience

China Economic Data Analysis — Lead Developer

Oct. 2025 – Present

Accounting Intern

Shandong Dongsheng Construction —

Mar. – Jun. 2024

Skills & Languages

Technical: Python (pandas, statsmodels, NumPy), Stata, SQL, $\LaTeX$, Git, JavaScript

Languages: English (C1), Chinese (Native), Spanish (A2)

Seeking: Pre-doctoral Research Assistant positions (2026–2027), with the long-term goal of a Ph.D. in Financial Economics.